

To Rage Freely
By Lucia Lorenz

She envied the sand within a sandstorm. She would watch the dirt beyond the property whirl and swirl through the wind, turning the air death-dealing. Hypnotized by the mess of a vengeful earth.

Everything seemed to turn upside down and right side up at once, until the sky became the same shade as the ground, a concrete-colored canvas broken only by pockets of air where life and sky peeked through, casting light into the ivory fog.

She listened to beads of sand pelt against the clean glass of the window and wondered if the tiny grains recognized it as one of their own, if they knew the glass had once been sand like them and flew toward it in longing.

Or perhaps they envied how their brothers and sisters had melted together, fused into one object, forever clinging to one another for support.

She admired the way the sand angered so freely, as if the earth itself had grown frustrated with the animals, humans, insects, and creatures that sank their tiny toes and claws into it, pushing and punishing it. In moments like these, the dirt and sand were finally free to rage.

The wind was artful and violent all at once. It moved as though the dust itself had grown curious of the land and wished, for a time, to walk the land beside it.

Or perhaps they were two silent assassins, whipping and bending through the air to deliver some tranquil, deathly blow, a simple duet.

Between the yellowish beads of dust, she saw something moving in the distance, flung wildly through the storm as though caught in a riptide, thrown under and over, again and again, with nothing to stop its flight.

She chuckled at the way the wind slapped the blurred foreign object. She was drawing nearer to the window, craving to hear the sharp pelt of debris against the glass.

Someone behind her called her name, trying to draw her attention, but she refused to turn away. She only smiled wider at the way the sand and wind had seized this wayward object and wielded it into a weapon.

The object drifted closer, its splinters and ledges slowly coming into view. A ladder flew through the air, pirouetting with graceful violence upon each peg, flipping until the bottom became the top and the top the bottom.

Hearing someone call her again, she felt her fingernails scrape against the window's wooden latch, compelled to open it and welcome the burn inside.

She stood there, gripping the frame, as the ladder soared straight toward the window.

Someone behind her yanked her out of the way just as the air, sand, and ladder tore a black hole into the room. Her hair whipped across her face as sharp glass bees stung her skin, and she felt the pressure of someone else's arms around her.

She laughed, head swinging back, as the wind and sand whirled in violent delight.